

THE OTHER ONE

Pre-Production Document for an In-Game Cutscene

GAME 326 — Cinematography for Games
Assignment 2 | Final Project Pre-Production

1. Game Design Context

The Other One is an in-game cutscene belonging to Awakening, a first-person psychological science-fiction horror game set within the corridors of a clandestine subterranean research facility. The visual style is photorealistic with a deliberately desaturated, chiaroscuro-driven aesthetic that combines sterile institutional surfaces with the residual decay of an abandoned space. Core mechanics privilege slow exploration, environmental observation, and audio-driven navigation; combat is minimal and stealth-adjacent. The narrative concerns a memory-stripped test subject who gradually pieces together fragments of their identity by traversing the facility. This particular cutscene occurs approximately one-third into the game, functioning as a mid-game revelation. After the protagonist has survived the initial corridors and begun to question the nature of the facility, they encounter a sealed laboratory containing another subject identical to themselves. The cutscene marks the precise narrative pivot where existential confusion crystallises into a specific, devastating realisation: the protagonist is one of many.

2. Premise & Logline

2.1 Premise

A test subject investigating a strange laboratory door discovers another test subject lying on a surgical table; the encounter triggers fragmented memories of his own experimentation, and he realises he is not unique but replicable.

2.2 Logline

When a memory-stripped test subject peers into a forbidden laboratory and finds an identical body lying on the operating table, the recognition shatters his sense of self and exposes the facility's true purpose.

3. Synopsis

The cutscene opens in a dim corridor of the research facility. The protagonist, designated Subject 08, advances slowly toward a door at the corridor's end from which warm light escapes. The camera tracks him from behind in a wide composition, emphasising the disproportion between his frail body and the oppressive architecture around him.

As he approaches, the angle shifts to a low push-in that frames him against the doorway's halo of light. He pauses in profile, listening; the camera glides slowly past his face, lingering on the focused tension in his jaw. He reaches forward, his hand entering frame in extreme close-up as he eases the door open.

The perspective shifts to first person. Crouching, leaning carefully through the threshold, he peers inside. The room beyond contains a surgical table, a suspended operating light, and the still figure of another subject — face turned slightly toward the doorway, exposed and immobilised. The camera glides forward in shallow focus, blurred at first, then resolving sharply onto the face.

The recognition is instantaneous. The face is his own. A Vertigo-style dolly zoom holds on this discovery while six rapid memory flashes erupt: blinding overhead lights, gloved hands, syringes, sterile mouths above him, his own past face rigid with fear, and finally the sleeping double on the table in the present. The flashes are punctuated by deep cinematic bass impacts.

The sequence collapses back to the present. The protagonist stumbles backwards out of the doorway, breath caught, body off-balance. A red emergency light begins to throb in the corridor as the facility's alarm registers his unauthorised presence. The final shot pulls high and wide, framing him as a small, motionless silhouette in a corridor washed crimson — alone with the knowledge that he is not the original. Cut to black.

4. Script

INT. ABANDONED CORRIDOR — RESEARCH FACILITY, LOWER LEVEL — NIGHT

A narrow service corridor stretches into darkness. Pipes and cables snake along the ceiling. At the far end, a heavy door is ajar — a sliver of warm light bleeds out across the floor tiles. Distant electrical hum. A low sub-bass drone, almost subliminal.

SUBJECT 08 (early thirties, gaunt, dressed in a torn hospital gown) walks cautiously forward. His footsteps are deliberate. He has been walking a long time.

SUBJECT 08 (V.O.)

(whispered, internal)

Another door. There's always another door.

He stops near the doorway. Listens. Only the hum.

SUBJECT 08 (V.O.)

Why does this one feel different.

INT. LABORATORY — CONTINUOUS

Through the gap, an operating room. A surgical table. A suspended overhead lamp casts cold light. On the table — a BODY. Restrained. Motionless. We do not see the face yet.

SUBJECT 08 crouches. Leans his head slowly past the doorframe. His pupils widen as the face on the table comes into focus.

CLOSE ON: the face on the table. It is HIS OWN FACE.

SUBJECT 08 (V.O.)

(barely audible)

...That's me.

FLASH MONTAGE — INT. LABORATORY — PAST — FRAGMENTED

Six rapid flashes, each two to four frames long, separated by black:

— BLINDING SURGICAL LIGHT directly overhead. Lens flare. WHITE FLASH.

— GLOVED HANDS reaching toward the camera. A SYRINGE. BASS IMPACT.

— BLURRED FIGURES IN WHITE COATS leaning down. Their faces obscured.

— CLOSE on his own EYE, dilated, watching the ceiling. A tear forming.

— SUBJECT 08's PAST FACE — younger, healthier, terrified — staring upward.

— THE BODY ON THE TABLE — present-day, identical face — eyes shut. MEGA FLASH.

INT. ABANDONED CORRIDOR — PRESENT — CONTINUOUS

Hard cut back. SUBJECT 08 stumbles backwards out of the doorway, hand against the wall. His breath comes ragged. A red emergency light begins to pulse from above. Distant: a SIREN, slow, mechanical.

SUBJECT 08 (V.O.)

How many of me are there?

He doesn't move. He can't move.

The camera RISES, slowly, until it observes him from above — a single small figure in a long, red-washed corridor, the doorway behind him still leaking its impossible light.

FADE TO BLACK.

END CUTSCENE.

5. Shot Script

The cutscene is constructed from sixteen shots distributed across three dramatic movements. The first movement (Shots 1–4, 30 seconds) is the approach: third-person camera work establishes the character within the corridor and tracks his deliberate progress toward the door. The second movement (Shots 5–7, 17 seconds) is the discovery: a first-person crouch and lean reveal the laboratory and the identical body within. The third movement (Shots 8–16,

43 seconds) is the recognition and aftermath: a Vertigo-style dolly zoom, a six-flash collision montage, and a high-wide closing composition that isolates the protagonist within the red-washed corridor. Total runtime is approximately 90 seconds. All keyframes for transitions employ Constant interpolation in Unreal Sequencer to produce hard cuts; the dolly zoom and the final high-wide use Cubic (Auto) interpolation for organic camera movement.

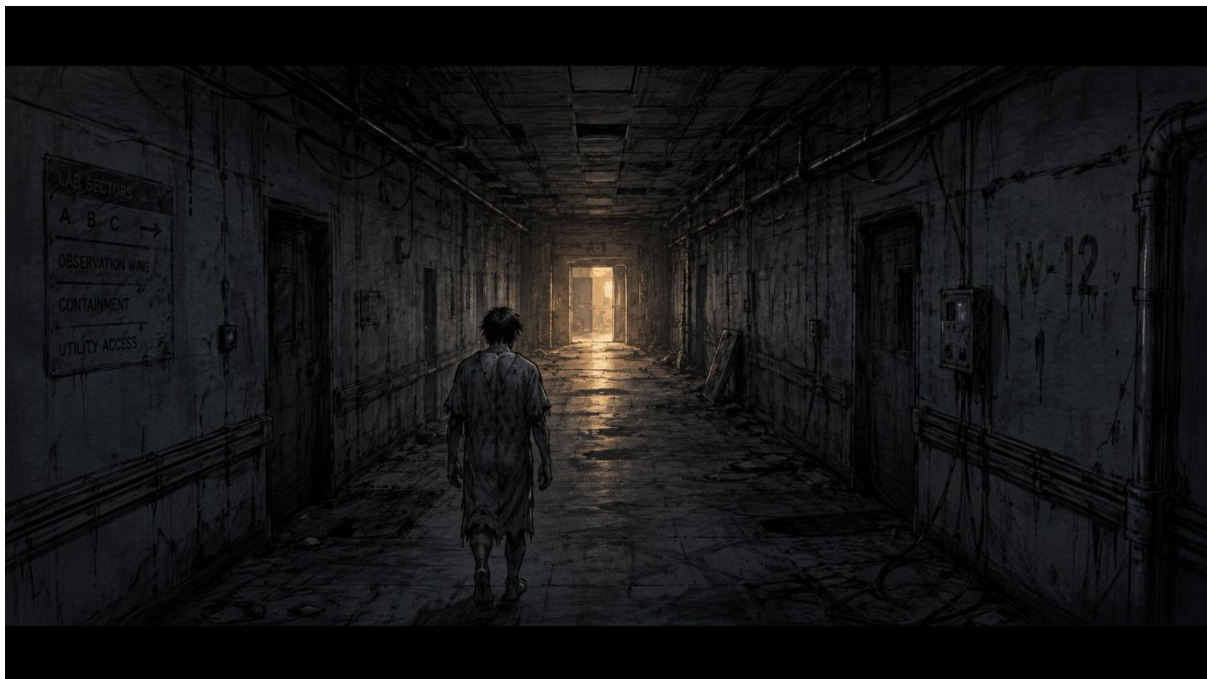
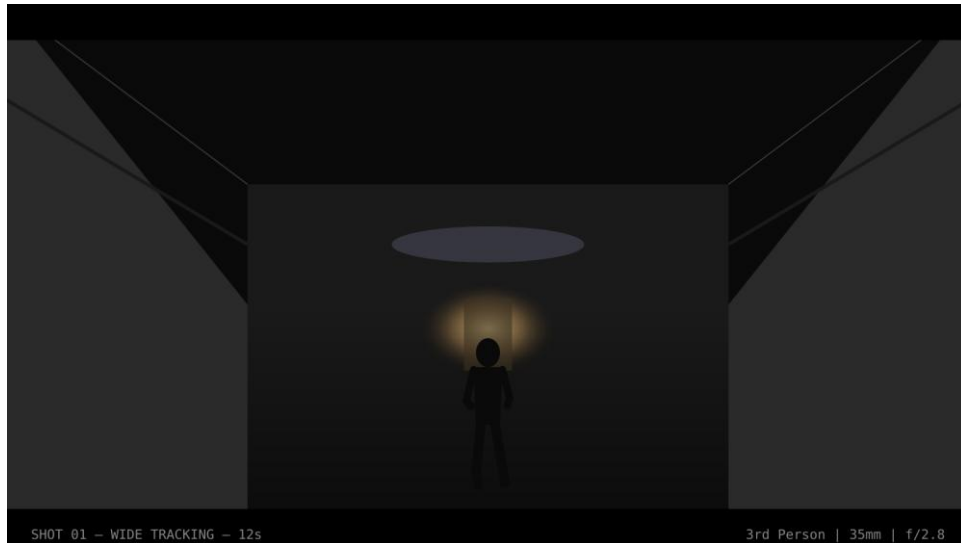
#	Type	Angle	Duration	Description & Rationale	5C Applied
01	Wide Tracking	3rd Person / Eye Level	12s	Camera tracks Subject 08 from behind as he walks down the corridor. Distant doorway light glows in the upper third. Establishes spatial geography and the disproportion between character and environment.	Composition (leading lines, Rule of Thirds), Camera Angles (objective)
02	Low Angle Push-In	Low (40cm) / Front	6s	Stationary camera at floor height; the character grows in frame as he approaches. The doorway light forms a halo around his head. Low angle ironically inflates a psychologically vulnerable character.	Camera Angles (ironic low angle), Composition (halo backlight)
03	Profile Slow Track	Side Profile / Eye Level	8s	Camera glides right-to-left in profile as the character stops and listens. Shallow depth of field; rim light from the doorway catches half his face. Negative space on the left builds tension.	Close-up (face), Composition (rim light, negative space)
04	Extreme Close-Up	Detail / Eye Level	4s	The character's hand reaches toward the door handle. Background is fully bokeh. Action match cut prepares the audience for the perspectival shift.	Close-up (extreme detail), Cutting (action match)
05	FPS Crouch & Lean	First Person / Low Lean	7s	Perspective shifts to first person. The camera dips downward (crouch), then leans sideways through the doorframe. The doorframe forms a 'frame within a frame' around the brightly lit interior.	Camera Angles (subjective shift), Composition (frame within frame)
06	POV Focus Pull	First Person / Low	7s	FPS continues. The focus animates from blurred (foreground table) to sharp (body lying on the table). Manual focus ramped from 100 to 250. Simulates dilation of attention.	Continuity (subjective continuation), Composition (focus reveal)
07	Subject CU (Chiaroscuro)	Profile CU / Eye Level	6s	Objective close-up of the lying subject's face in profile, half lit by the surgical lamp. A single flicker exposes the face fully for one frame. Dramatic chiaroscuro lighting.	Close-up (dramatic detail), Cutting (subjective→objective)
08	Dolly Zoom (Vertigo)	Continuous / Eye Level	4s	Focal length zooms from 100mm to 50mm while camera tracks backward — face remains centred but background warps. Visualises the protagonist's psychological collapse of identity.	Camera Angles (warping), Cutting (continuous take)
09	Flash 1 — Overhead Light	POV Up / Past	0.13s	White-blown POV of the surgical lamp above (Exposure +10). Disorienting brightness.	Cutting (collision montage), Close-up (extreme)

#	Type	Angle	Duration	Description & Rationale	5C Applied
10	Flash 2 — Gloved Hands	POV Up / Past	0.13s	Hands and syringe reaching toward the camera (Exposure 0, normal). Threat made tactile.	Cutting, Close-up (detail)
11	Flash 3 — Scientists	POV Up / Past	0.17s	Blurred white-coat figures leaning over the camera (Exposure +8). Faces deliberately illegible.	Cutting, Composition (ambiguity)
12	Flash 4 — Eye	Extreme CU / Past	0.13s	Extreme close-up of his own dilated eye, watching the ceiling (Exposure 0).	Close-up (extreme), Cutting
13	Flash 5 — Past Face	Front Profile / Past	0.17s	His past self's face — fearful, intact (Exposure +12, MEGA flash). The original.	Cutting (climactic), Close-up
14	Flash 6 — Present Body	Profile CU / Present	0.17s	Match-cut back to the body on the table from Shot 7 (Exposure +15, MEGA flash). Past and present collapse into a single image.	Cutting (match cut across time), Continuity
15	Stumble Back Wide	3rd Person / Eye Level	10s	Hard smash cut to third-person side view. Subject 08 stumbles backward, off balance. Red alarm light ramps in (intensity 0 → 60). Doorway still glows warm.	Camera Angles (return to objective), Cutting (smash cut)
16	Final High Wide	High Angle (2m) / Wide	14s	Camera rises slowly to a high angle. Character occupies lower-right third as a small silhouette. Red wash dominates upper frame; doorway light forms a parallelogram on the floor. CCTV-like vignette.	Composition (terminal wide), Camera Angles (high angle)

6. Storyboard

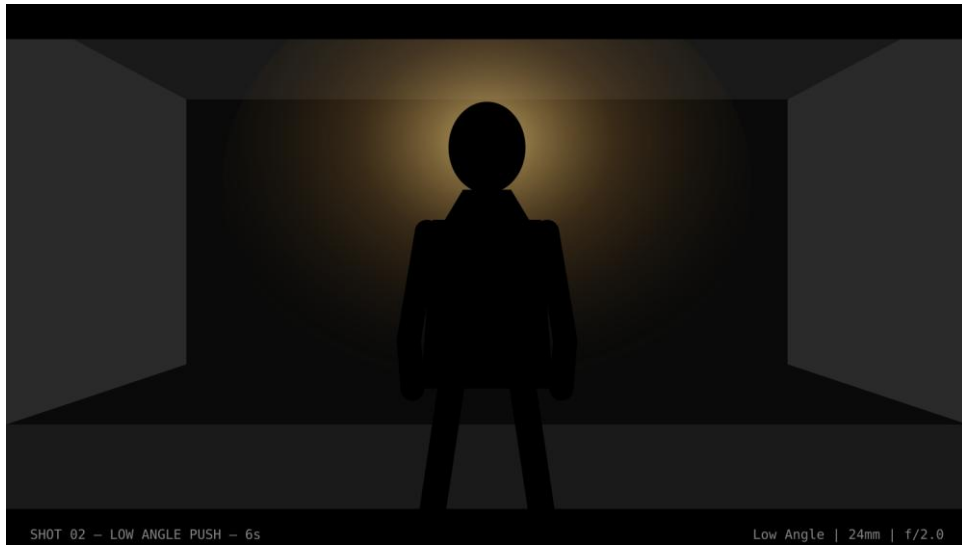
Eight key frames have been rendered from the planned sixteen-shot sequence. Each frame illustrates the intended composition, lighting motivation, and character blocking. The frames are presented in narrative order and labelled with their corresponding shot number, camera type, lens specification, and intended duration. Letterbox bars indicate the final cinematic aspect ratio.

Frame 1 — Wide Tracking (Shot 01)



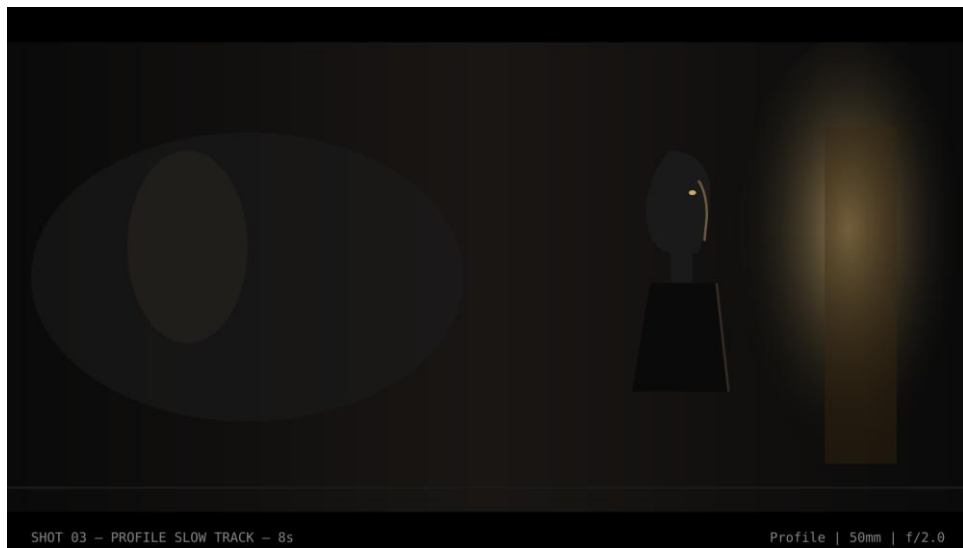
Subject 08 walking down the corridor toward the distant doorway. Camera tracks from behind at eye level. Warm light bleeds from the door; ceiling-light tiles establish recurring overhead motif.

Frame 2 — Low Angle Push (Shot 02)



The character approaches camera; low angle exaggerates his presence and produces a halo of door-light around his head. Forward-walking pose suggests determination he does not yet feel.

Frame 3 — Profile Slow Track (Shot 03)



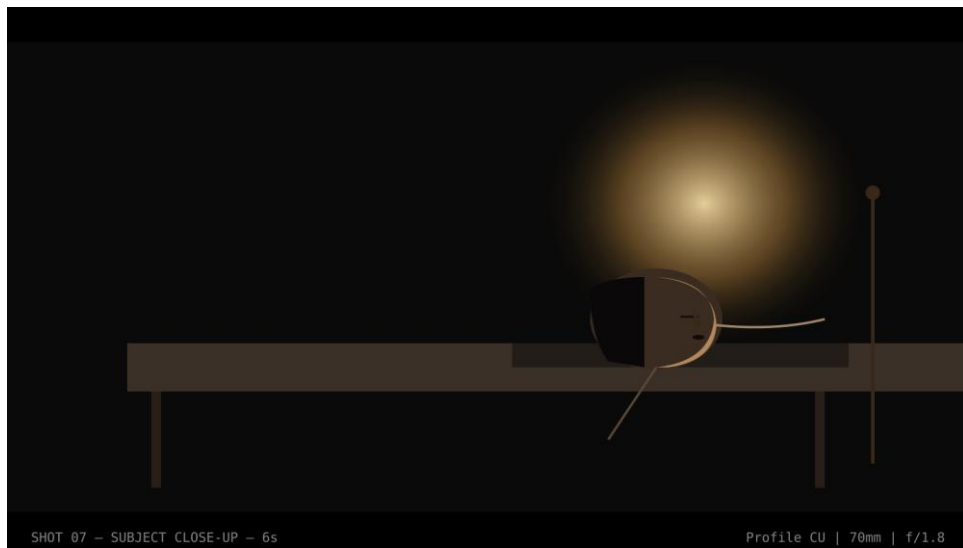
Side profile of the character paused at the doorway. Rim light catches one side of his face; the other half is in shadow. Negative space on the left creates compositional tension.

Frame 4 — FPS Crouch & Lean (Shot 05)



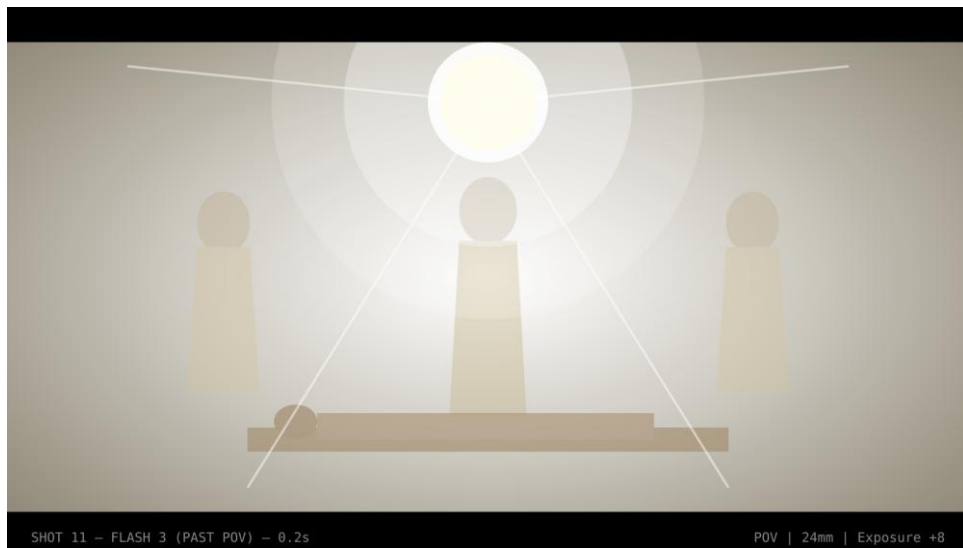
First-person view through the doorframe. The frame-within-a-frame composition reveals the surgical bed, hanging light, and the still figure inside the laboratory. Player vision is partially obscured.

Frame 5 — Subject Close-Up (Shot 07)



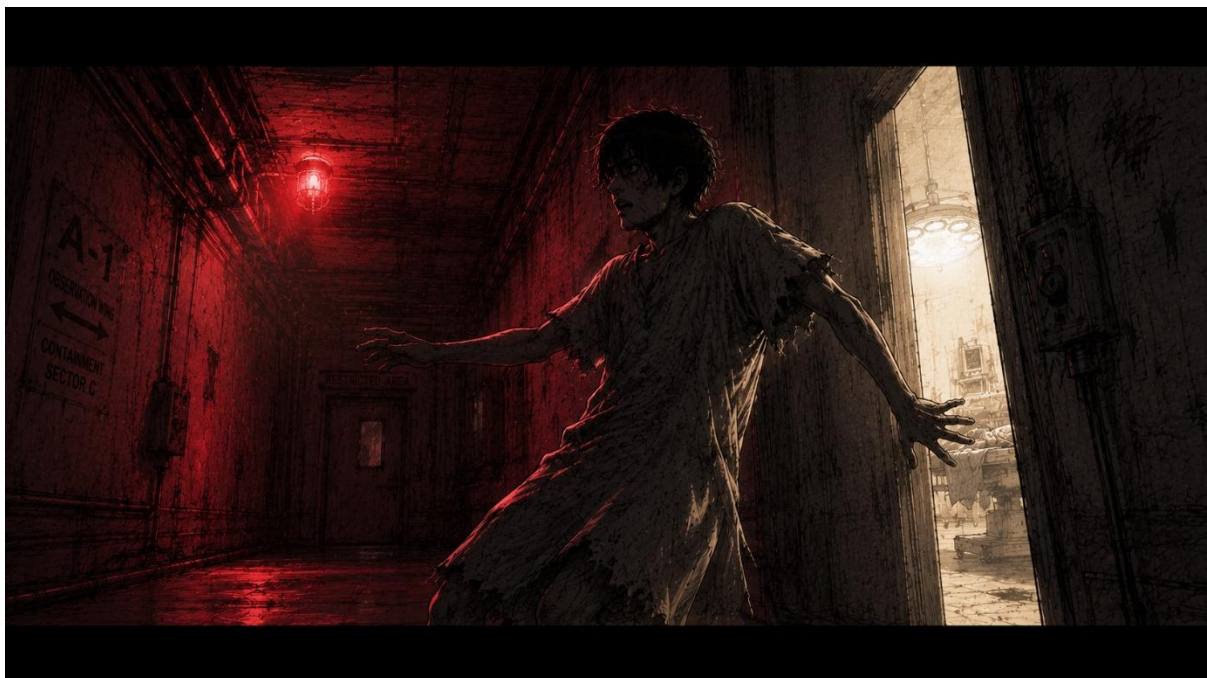
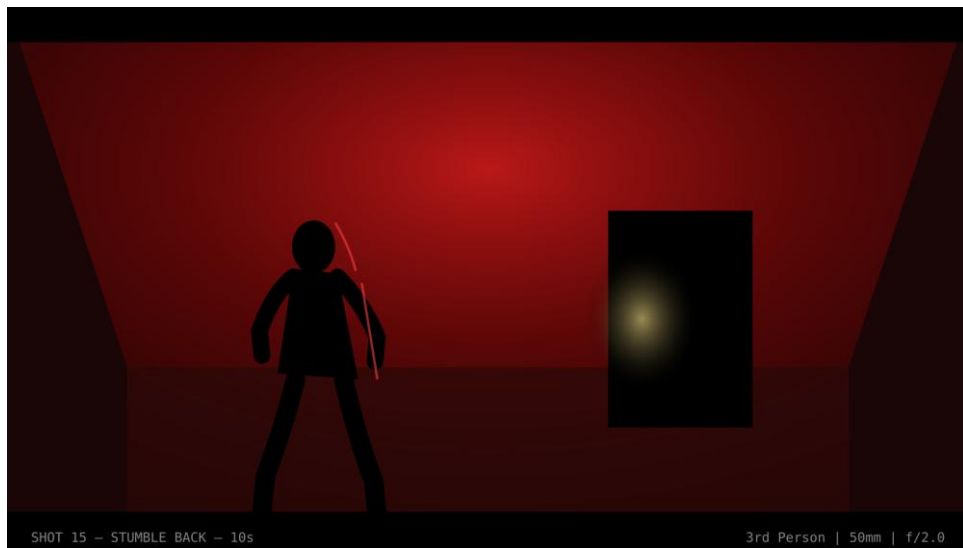
Chiaroscuro profile close-up of the body on the operating table. Half the face is lit, half in deep shadow. Medical tubing exits the frame. The face is deliberately legible: it is identical to the protagonist.

Frame 6 — Flash 3, Past POV (Shot 11)



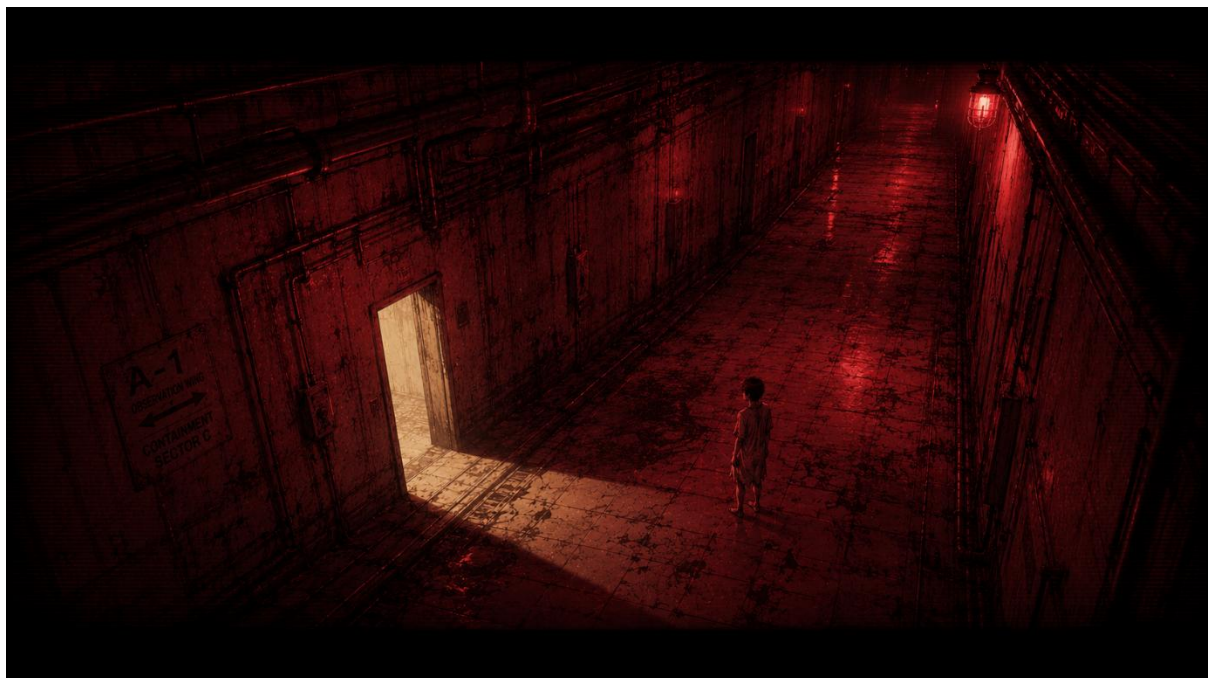
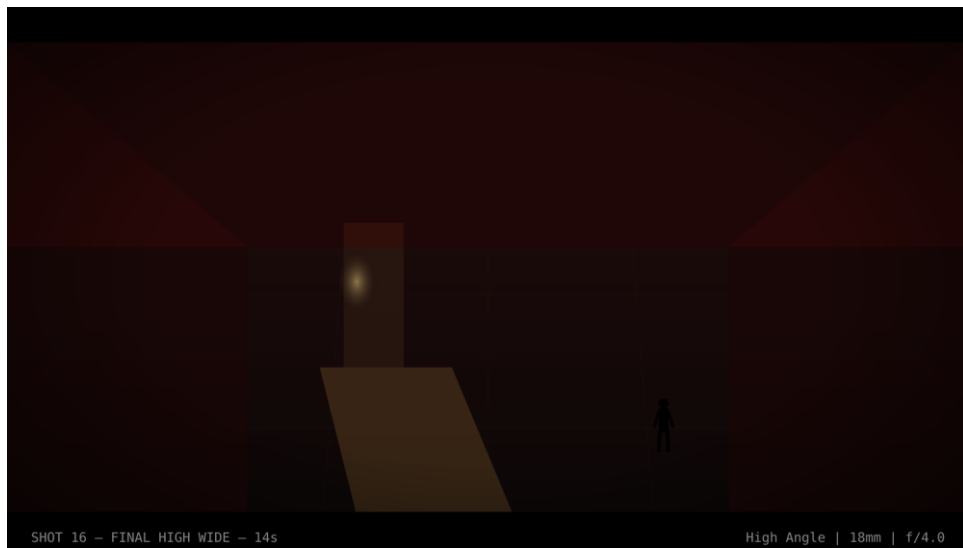
Memory fragment: overexposed flash of white-coated figures looming over the camera position. Faces deliberately illegible. The surgical light dominates as a blinding sun. Lens flare washes the frame.

Frame 7 — Stumble Back Recovery (Shot 15)



Smash cut to third person. The character staggers backwards, arms reaching for balance. Red alarm light has flooded the corridor; the doorway still glows warm in contrast — past warmth versus present alarm.

Frame 8 — Final High Wide (Shot 16)



Closing composition: high-angle wide of the corridor washed crimson. Subject 08 stands small and motionless at lower-right third. The doorway light forms a parallelogram on the floor — a window into the truth he cannot unsee.

Credits

Direction, cinematography, and pre-production: Kaan Eskikalci.

Tools planned for production: Unreal Engine 5.5 (Sequencer, Cine Camera Actor, Post Process Volume), Modular Hospital asset pack (Fab), Mixamo character animations, Freesound.org audio library, Adobe Audition for sound mixing.